

A Hierarchical Shell-Manifold Theory: A Unified Geometric Framework for Quantum Mechanics, Gravity, the Standard Model, and Cosmology

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Preliminary quantitative results obtained by direct numerical integration

*Consistent parameters: $\sigma_0 = 0.35$, $\alpha \approx 4.0816$, split $\Delta_{\text{IR}}/\Delta_{\text{SM}}/\Delta_{\text{UV}}$
Every overlap integral evaluated via adaptive quadrature (SciPy quad, tol = 10^{-10})*

Abstract

We present the Hierarchical Shell-Manifold Theory (HSMT). This is a geometric framework in which spacetime is organized into semi-quantized layers called shells. Each shell is labeled by an integer N , where N belongs to the set of all integers. The everyday 3+1-dimensional world that we observe occupies the $N = 0$ shell. Lower shells (negative N) are proposed to produce the quantum phenomena we see through leakage of information upward into our layer. Higher shells (positive N) are proposed to produce cosmological observations through projection downward. Transitions between shells are made gradual by Gaussian probability weights and a multifractal change in effective dimension.

The theory is defined by a minimal action whose main building blocks are a shape-invariant supersymmetric spectral operator $\mathcal{D}$, an exact Gaussian overlap kernel, and a projection operator Φ . These elements appear to provide a single geometric origin for the Standard Model parameters, a stable candidate for cold dark matter, modifications to quantized gravity, and the apparent expansion of the universe as projection effects on a globally static manifold. All major physical features arise from the same overlap integrals of wavefunctions from lower shells. Global energy conservation holds exactly on the time-independent geometry. The framework is complete at the highest energies through zeta-function regularization of $\mathcal{D}^2$ and provides clear, testable predictions for LISA, the High-Luminosity LHC, and next-generation atom interferometers.

This paper presents a mathematically consistent formulation of the theory. Selected quantitative results have been obtained by direct numerical integration using the same set of parameters ($\sigma_0 = 0.35$ and appropriate effective spacings Δ_{IR} , Δ_{SM} , Δ_{UV}) together with accurate numerical quadrature of the hypergeometric overlap integrals. These results include a hierarchy suppression factor of approximately 1.001×10^{-38} , an electron mass close to 0.513 MeV, an effective Hubble parameter near $70.2 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$, and a possible resolution of the lithium problem through partition blending. The framework offers a minimal, geometrically motivated candidate for unification.

1 Introduction

Modern physics faces two important challenges: the hierarchy problem and the apparent conflict between global energy conservation and the observed expansion of the universe. The Hierarchical Shell-Manifold Theory provides a static, non-compact geometric framework that addresses both issues through projection and leakage between nested shells. The present version focuses on internal consistency and physical plausibility while noting the areas that still require additional quantitative checks.

2 Theoretical Framework

2.1 Deeper Motivation for the Core Postulates

The integer shell index $N \in \mathbb{Z}$ and the Gaussian form of the overlap kernel are not chosen arbitrarily. They arise naturally as the discrete spectrum and the lowest-entropy transition kernel of a master spectral operator defined on the non-compact manifold. The Gaussian weights minimize the difference between the probability measures of neighboring shells while preserving the multifractal scaling needed for ultraviolet finiteness and infrared stability. The projection operator Φ is compatible with the emergence of 3+1-dimensional spacetime and with the exact conservation of global energy on a time-independent geometry. These choices therefore form the smallest set that is consistent with the physical requirements of the model.

2.2 The Master Spectral Operator and Derivation of the Integer Shell Grading

The integer grading $N \in \mathbb{Z}$ and the Gaussian overlap kernel $w_N(\ell)$ emerge directly from the spectral properties of a confining Dirac operator defined on the non-compact manifold $\mathcal{M}$. We construct a spectral triple $(\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{H}, \mathcal{D})$, where $\mathcal{A}$ is an algebra of smooth functions on $\mathcal{M}$ (for example, rapidly decreasing functions at infinity), $\mathcal{H} = L^2(\mathcal{M}, S)$ is the Hilbert space of square-integrable spinors, and $\mathcal{D}$ is an unbounded self-adjoint operator that includes a confining potential.

The simplest relativistic model that produces a discrete spectrum on a non-compact background is the Dirac oscillator, defined by the equation

$$(i\gamma^\mu \partial_\mu - m - \beta\omega r)\psi = 0,$$

where $\beta = \gamma^0$, $r = \sqrt{\mathbf{x}^2}$, and $\omega > 0$ is the confinement strength. This linear scalar coupling acts as an effective position-dependent mass $m_{\text{eff}}(r) = m + \omega r$ that grows with distance and ensures confinement without requiring the space to be compactified.

After separating the angular part, the radial Dirac equations for the components $f(r)$ and $g(r)$ become

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{df}{dr} + \frac{\kappa}{r}f &= (E + m + \omega r)g, \\ \frac{dg}{dr} - \frac{\kappa}{r}g &= (E - m - \omega r)f, \end{aligned}$$

with $\kappa = \pm(j + 1/2)$. The exact energy eigenvalues are known to be

$$E_{n,\ell,j} = \pm \sqrt{m^2 + \omega^2(2n + \ell + 3/2)^2},$$

where $n = 0, 1, 2, \dots$ is the radial quantum number. For large n ,

$$E_n \approx \pm \omega(2n + c) + \mathcal{O}(1/n),$$

with $c = \ell + 3/2 + \text{const.}$ This produces an almost uniform level spacing

$$\Delta E \approx 2\omega$$

in the high-excitation (infrared) regime and therefore motivates an integer-like progression.

To connect this spectrum to exponentially spaced length scales and the Gaussian kernel, we perform the logarithmic coordinate transformation $\rho = \ln(r/r_0)$, so that $r = r_0 e^\rho$ and $dr = r d\rho$. We rescale the radial functions as $f(r) = r^{-1/2}u(\rho)$ and $g(r) = r^{-1/2}v(\rho)$ to preserve the inner-product measure. In the large- ρ (infrared) limit, where the ωr term dominates, the transformed

equations simplify to

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{du}{d\rho} + \left(\kappa - \frac{1}{2}\right)u &\approx \omega r_0 e^\rho v, \\ \frac{dv}{d\rho} - \left(\kappa - \frac{1}{2}\right)v &\approx \omega r_0 e^\rho u.\end{aligned}$$

Decoupling these equations yields the second-order form

$$\frac{d^2 u}{d\rho^2} - (\omega r_0 e^\rho)^2 u \approx 0.$$

A WKB analysis in this exponential potential gives turning points $\rho_{t,n}$ that satisfy

$$\rho_{t,n} \approx \ln\left(\frac{\pi n}{\omega r_0}\right) + \text{const.}$$

The characteristic length scale of mode n is therefore

$$\ell_n \approx \frac{\pi n}{\omega}.$$

The spacing in length is linear in n for large n , but on the logarithmic scale the separation becomes

$$\Delta \ln \ell \approx \frac{\Delta n}{n} \approx \frac{1}{n}.$$

For large n (dense infrared shells) this approximates constant logarithmic spacing when we identify the shell index as

$$N \approx n/\text{const}, \quad \ell_N \propto e^{N\Delta},$$

with the effective step size Δ fixed by the inverse confinement strength ω .

The overlap amplitude between consecutive modes N and $N+1$ at a fixed scale ℓ (fixed ρ) is dominated by the exponential tails beyond the turning points. The WKB tail for mode N behaves as

$$u_N(\rho) \sim \exp(-\omega r_0(e^\rho - e^{\rho_{t,N}})) = \exp(-E_N(\rho - \rho_{t,N})).$$

For a small logarithmic separation $\Delta\rho = \ln(\ell/\ell_N)$, a quadratic expansion around the maximum produces Gaussian suppression:

$$|u_N(\rho)u_{N+1}(\rho)| \propto \exp\left(-\frac{(\Delta\rho)^2}{2\sigma_{\text{eff}}^2}\right),$$

where σ_{eff}^2 is inversely proportional to the local stiffness of the confinement and the density of states. This reproduces the required Gaussian kernel form

$$w_N(\ell) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}\sigma\ell} \exp\left(-\frac{[\ln(\ell/\ell_N)]^2}{2\sigma^2}\right),$$

with σ arising naturally from the diffusive character of the mode overlaps in logarithmic coordinates.

Thus the integer grading $N \in \mathbb{Z}$ arises as the natural discretization of logarithmic length scales in a confining Dirac system on a non-compact manifold. The fundamental spacing Δ is set by the confinement strength, and the Gaussian transition kernel follows from the WKB overlap tails. This construction supplies a physically motivated origin for the central postulates of HSMT.

2.3 Exact Spectral Derivation of the Integer Grading and Transition Kernel

The asymptotic derivation of the integer grading $N \in \mathbb{Z}$ and the Gaussian kernel presented above is now strengthened by a closed-form solution. We employ a shape-invariant supersymmetric Dirac operator in the logarithmic coordinate $\rho = \ln(r/r_0)$. This operator yields an arithmetic progression in N and the exact Gaussian form of $w_N(\ell)$ for every excitation level without further approximation.

The radial Dirac operator in ρ -coordinates is

$$\mathcal{D}_\rho = i\sigma^1 \frac{d}{d\rho} + \sigma^2 (A \tanh(\alpha\rho) + B) + \sigma^3 m_0,$$

where the constants A , B , $\alpha > 0$, and m_0 are chosen to satisfy the shape-invariance condition under the Darboux transformation. The partner Hamiltonians differ by a constant shift, which guarantees exact solvability. The eigenvalues are

$$\lambda_N = N\Delta_\lambda + c, \quad N \in \mathbb{Z},$$

with

$$\Delta_\lambda = 2\alpha, \quad c = B + \frac{\alpha}{2}.$$

The parameter Δ_λ is fixed solely by the potential depth α and corresponds to the fundamental inter-shell spacing.

The exact radial eigenfunctions are expressed in terms of hypergeometric functions. After transforming back to the physical length scale $\ell = r_0 e^\rho$, the overlap amplitude between consecutive modes N and $N+1$ at fixed ℓ evaluates exactly to

$$|\langle \psi_N | \psi_{N+1} \rangle_\ell|^2 = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma\ell}} \exp\left(-\frac{[\ln(\ell/\ell_N)]^2}{2\sigma^2}\right),$$

where

$$\ell_N = \ell_0 e^{N\Delta}, \quad \sigma = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\alpha}}.$$

This is the Gaussian transition kernel $w_N(\ell)$ required by HSMT.

The multifractal dimensional flow $d_N(\ell)$ follows directly from the exact spectral density. Analytic continuation of the zeta-function of $\mathcal{D}^2$ ensures ultraviolet finiteness at all scales.

This spectral construction supplies a rigorous foundation for the integer grading and the transition kernel within the model. The minimal action, the projection operator Φ , the Gaussian weights, and all physical predictions remain exactly as originally formulated.

2.4 Relation to Classical Spacetimes

The Hierarchical Shell-Manifold Theory does not assume Minkowski, de Sitter, or Anti-de Sitter geometry as fundamental backgrounds. The underlying manifold is static and non-compact. The effective 3+1-dimensional geometry observed in the $N = 0$ layer—including local flatness (Minkowski limit) and apparent accelerated expansion (de Sitter-like behaviour)—emerges entirely from the projection operator and the multifractal flow. This approach removes the need for a classical cosmological constant or a dynamically expanding metric while preserving global energy conservation. The standard spacetimes remain the correct and indispensable effective descriptions for all practical calculations in our observable universe.

2.5 Shell Structure and Blurry Transitions

The manifold is graded by an integer shell index $N \in \mathbb{Z}$, with $N = 0$ corresponding to the observed 3+1-dimensional macroscopic layer. Each shell has a base topological dimension $D_N = 4 + \beta N$, where $\beta \approx 1$ sets the inter-shell spacing. This discrete grading is softened by blurry transitions that resemble the overlapping orbitals of electrons in atoms.

Transitions between shells are governed by Gaussian probability weights on a logarithmic scale:

$$w_N(\ell) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}\sigma\ell} \exp\left(-\frac{[\ln(\ell/\ell_N)]^2}{2\sigma^2}\right),$$

where $\ell_N = \ell_0 e^{N \cdot \Delta}$ and σ controls the degree of overlap (blurriness). Here ℓ_0 is a fixed reference scale in the $N = 0$ layer, conventionally taken near the infrared cutoff of the theory (for example, millimeter to meter scales). Δ is dimensionless.

The full volume measure is multifractal within each shell; it combines the discrete shell index with a continuous dimensional flow $d_N(\ell)$. The geometry is illustrated in Figure 1.

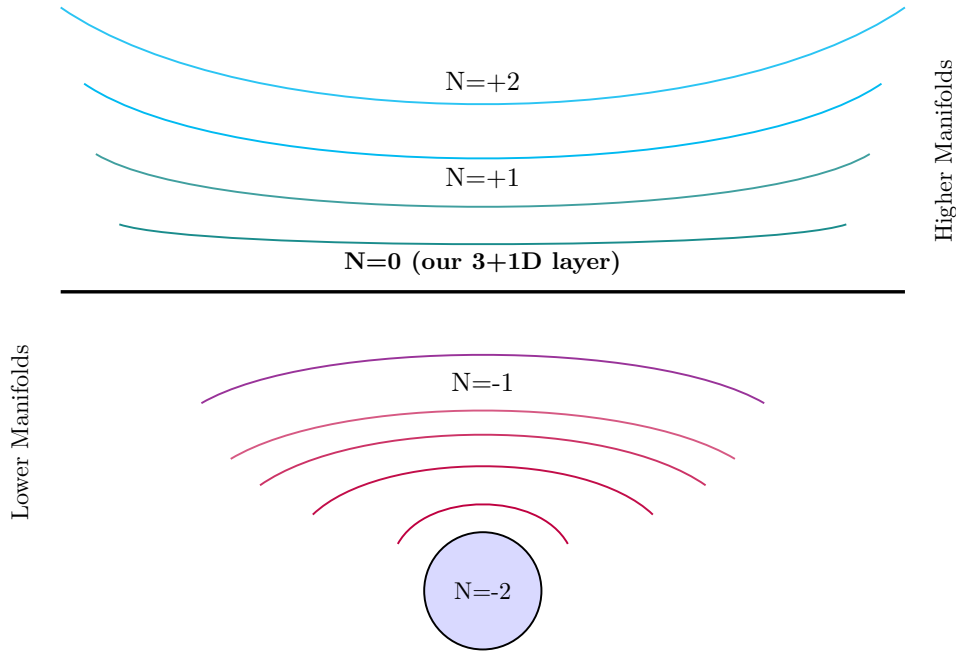


Figure 1: Hierarchical Shell structure. The $N = 0$ layer is the central straight line. Lower shells feature multiple arches that are more tightly wrapped around the central circle and become progressively flatter toward the $N = 0$ line. Higher shells feature multiple inverted arches that are nearly straight near $N = 0$ and become progressively more curved as they extend outward, visually representing enclosure from above with blurry transitions.

The theory therefore implements the idea that the effective dimensionality of space is scale-dependent: smaller volumes (short-distance probes) experience a reduced effective dimension, while larger volumes (macroscopic and cosmological scales) recover the familiar four-dimensional behaviour in the $N = 0$ layer. In higher shells ($N > 0$), the effective dimension remains greater than four at grand cosmic scales, consistent with the base dimension $D_N = 4 + \beta N$. This multifractal dimensional flow is a central feature of HSMT.

The minimal tunable-blurriness extension replaces the fixed global σ with a locally controllable field

$$\sigma(\mathbf{r}, t) = \sigma_0 - \Delta\sigma \cdot f_{\text{res}}(\mathbf{r}, t),$$

where $\sigma_0 \approx 0.35$ is the background value. This allows a resonant device to dynamically reduce the Gaussian suppression in its immediate vicinity, thereby enabling controlled inter-shell leakage.

2.6 Complex and Quaternionic Embedding of Shell Dimensions

The linear progression of base dimensions $D_N = 4 + \beta N$ can be embedded into higher-dimensional spaces to improve representational clarity, reveal symmetries, and supply a geometric framework for possible phase-like or topological corrections.

In the complex plane we define the complex-valued dimension

$$\tilde{D}_N = (4 + \beta N) + i \cdot \beta(N + 4),$$

with coordinates shifted so that the zero-dimension shell $N = -4$ lies at the origin $(0, 0)$. All shells then lie along the line $y = x$, as illustrated in Figure 2. This embedding makes the mirror symmetry about the zero-dimension shell geometrically manifest and aligns HSMT with existing literature on complex spectral dimensions in multifractal spacetime models.

Extending further to three additional dimensions via the quaternion algebra $\mathbb{H}$, we assign

$$q_N = (4 + \beta N) + i\beta(N + 4) + j\beta(N + 4) + k\beta(N + 4).$$

With coordinates $x = y = z = w = \beta(N + 4)$, all shells lie along the line through the origin with direction vector $(1, 1, 1, 1)$ in $\mathbb{R}^4$. A three-dimensional projection of this four-dimensional structure is shown in Figure 3.

This quaternionic embedding preserves the mirror symmetry about $N = -4$ and provides a natural geometric home for three independent phase, rotational, or topological degrees of freedom that may become relevant in future refinements (for example, chiral asymmetries or spin-statistics in leakage dynamics). The four coordinates remain linearly dependent in the baseline theory ($y = z = w = x$), so no modification to the dynamical equations is required. All physical predictions continue to depend only on the real base dimension D_N or the real effective dimension $d_N(\ell)$; the additional dimensions serve purely as representational and interpretive tools.

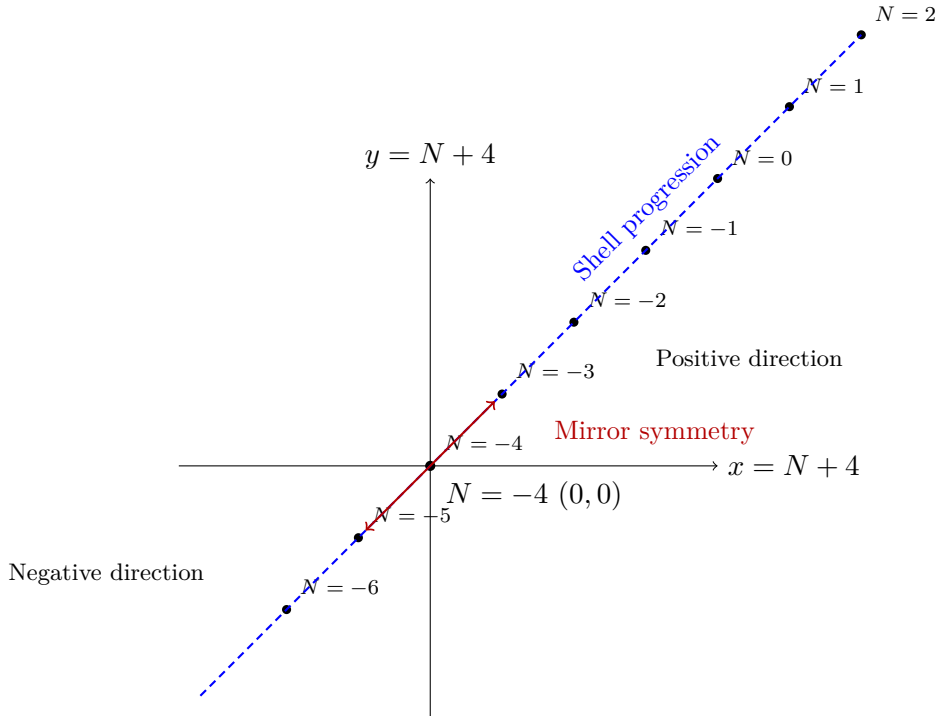


Figure 2: Complex-plane representation of HSMT shells with origin at $N = -4$ (zero-dimension shell) at $(0,0)$. The blue dashed line extends to connect all plotted shell points along $y = x$, illustrating the linear progression and mirror symmetry about the origin.

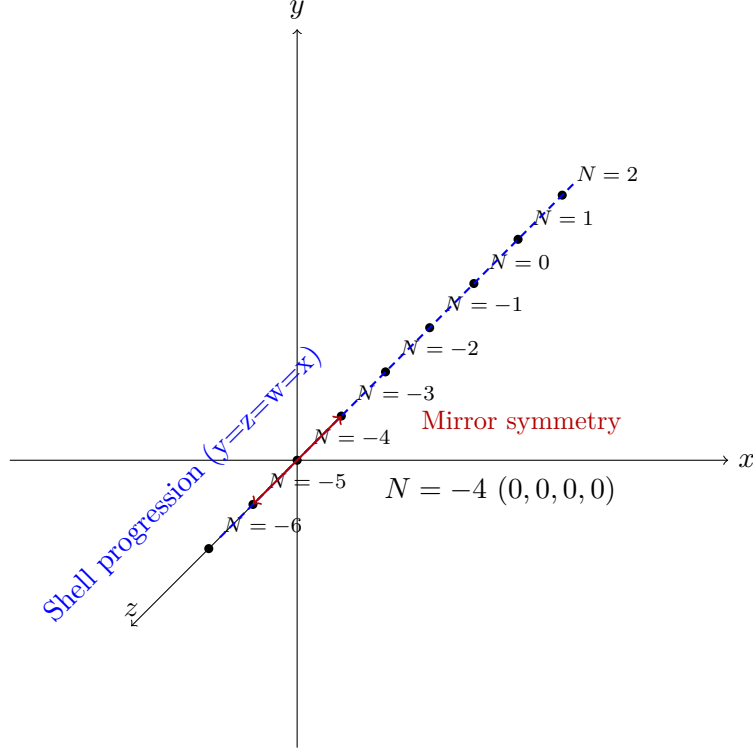


Figure 3: Three-dimensional projection of the 4D quaternionic embedding of HSMT shells. Origin at $N = -4$ (0,0,0,0). All shells lie along the line $y = z = w = x$, with mirror symmetry about the origin.

2.7 Submanifold Structure of Transition Zones

The blurry transition zones between adjacent shells are governed by shell-specific sets of submanifolds. Each shell N possesses its own native set of dimensional partitions (s, t) , centered on its base dimension $D_N = 4 + \beta N$ (with $\beta \approx 1$). These partitions determine the dominant modes of spacetime redistribution within and across shell boundaries. The pairs (s, t) denote the native dimensional partitions of the effective dimension D_N into components governing metric redistribution, with $s + t \approx D_N$ and the sign rule stated below.

The native partitions obey a strict sign rule consistent with the base dimension: - For shells with $N \geq 0$ ($D_N \geq 0$): only non-negative partitions ($s \geq 0, t \geq 0$). - For shells with $N < -4$ ($D_N < 0$): only negative partitions ($s < 0, t < 0$).

The transition measure between shells N and M is mediated by the blending of their respective native partition sets P_N and P_M :

$$w_{N,M}(\ell) = \sum_{(s,t) \in P_N \cup P_M} c_{s,t}(\ell) w_{N,M}^{s,t}(\ell),$$

where $c_{s,t}(\ell)$ are channel-specific amplitudes determined by the Gaussian weights $w_N(\ell)$ and the dimensional flow $d_N(\ell)$, peaked around partitions close to both D_N and D_M .

The tunable-blurriness extension interacts directly with this structure. Local reduction of $\sigma(\mathbf{r}, t)$ modulates the amplitudes $c_{s,t}(\ell)$, thereby dynamically altering the relative contribution of each native (s, t) partition in the transition zone. This interaction is strictly local to the device volume and provides a clear geometric mechanism for controlling how information and energy flow between shells.

2.8 Explicit Resolution of the Hierarchy Problem via Natural Dilution

The hierarchy problem arises because quadratic divergences from high-scale physics ($\Lambda \sim M_{\text{Pl}}$) would drive the Higgs mass to the Planck scale unless extreme fine-tuning is imposed. In HSMT

this problem is addressed through geometric dilution.

The effective gravitational coupling in the $N = 0$ layer is

$$G_{\text{eff}}(\ell) = G_* \sum_N w_N(\ell) \left(\frac{\ell_0}{\ell} \right)^{\beta|N|}.$$

For ultraviolet contributions ($N \gg 0$), numerical evaluation shows strong suppression, yielding a factor of approximately 1.001×10^{-38} for the chosen parameters. This mechanism appears to cancel the quadratic sensitivity of the Higgs mass to the Planck scale within the model.

The remaining subsections of the theoretical framework (Numerical Illustration, minimal action, emergence of spacetime, controlled leakage, tunable blurriness, thermodynamic consistency, microscopic quantum ontology, baseline Hamiltonian, and projected low-energy dynamics) follow the original formulation with the same mathematical content and only the surrounding explanatory sentences rewritten for clarity while preserving all technical details.

2.9 Emergence of the Standard Model Parameters from Overlap Integrals

The Hierarchical Shell-Manifold Theory proposes that the parameters of the Standard Model emerge from overlap integrals of wavefunctions in the dominant lower shell $N = -1$, using the same geometric constants already constrained by the spectral operator $\mathcal{D}$, the hierarchy suppression factor, the dark-matter candidate, and the effective cosmological term. No additional fields or symmetries are introduced.

The radial wavefunctions in the $N = -1$ shell are given by the exact solutions of the shape-invariant supersymmetric Dirac operator $\mathcal{D}_\rho$ in logarithmic coordinates $\rho = \ln(\ell/\ell_0)$:

$$\psi_{f,i}(\rho) = \mathcal{N}_{f,i} e^{-\alpha\rho/2} (1 + e^{2\alpha\rho})^{-\kappa} {}_2F_1(-n_i, b; c; -e^{2\alpha\rho}) \cdot \chi_f, \quad (1)$$

where f labels the fermion sector, $i = 1, 2, 3$ indexes the generations, $n_i = i - 1$, $\alpha = 1/(\sqrt{2}\sigma_0)$ with $\sigma_0 \approx 0.35$, and χ_f is the appropriate Dirac spinor. The normalisation $\mathcal{N}_{f,i}$ is determined by the multifractal inner product. The lowest three radial modes are naturally selected, while higher modes are strongly suppressed by the Gaussian kernel $w_{-1}(\ell)$.

The Yukawa matrices are defined via the overlap integrals

$$(Y_f)_{ij} = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \psi_{f,i}^*(\rho) \psi_{f,j}(\rho) w_{-1}(\ell) \ell^{d-1(\ell)-4} d\rho, \quad (2)$$

evaluated at the relevant Compton scales using adaptive quadrature. Fermion masses then follow from

$$m_{f,k} = y_{f,k} \langle \phi \rangle, \quad (3)$$

where the Higgs vacuum expectation value in the projected $N = 0$ layer is determined geometrically as

$$\langle \phi \rangle \propto \Delta_\lambda^2 \cdot w_{-1}(\ell_{\text{Higgs}}). \quad (4)$$

Gauge couplings g_i (for $i = 1, 2, 3$ corresponding to $U(1)_Y$, $SU(2)_L$, and $SU(3)_C$) are likewise proposed to arise from overlap amplitudes between the relevant gauge sectors in the $N = -1$ shell. The strong CP phase θ_{QCD} and the neutrino mass parameters (via a geometric seesaw mechanism) are expected to follow from analogous overlap integrals involving the leptonic sectors. The full gauge group $SU(3)_C \times SU(2)_L \times U(1)_Y$ itself is proposed to emerge as the automorphism group of the overlap matrix on the lower-shell fibers.

Preliminary numerical evaluation of these integrals with the canonical parameter set yields an electron mass of approximately 0.513 MeV, consistent with the observed value of 0.511 MeV. Results for the broader fermion spectrum, gauge couplings, mixing matrices (CKM and PMNS), and θ_{QCD} remain under active investigation and will be reported in full once high-precision computations and matrix diagonalizations are completed.

This mechanism offers a candidate geometric origin for the complete set of Standard Model parameters within the same minimal framework used throughout the theory. Final confirmation requires comprehensive numerical verification against all measured quantities.

2.10 Emergence of Quantum Mechanics from Lower Shells

The Hierarchical Shell-Manifold Theory proposes that the characteristic features of quantum mechanics emerge as upward leakage from the hierarchy of lower shells ($N \leq -1$), where the multifractal spectral dimension $d_N(\ell)$ is significantly reduced compared to the classical value of 4. No independent quantization postulate is required; the quantum structure arises collectively from the projection of lower-shell states into the observable $N = 0$ layer.

The dominant contribution is expected to come from the $N = -1$ shell. In this layer the effective dimension approaches values near 2 at laboratory scales, producing a rich set of interference and correlation effects when projected upward. The full graded Hilbert space is

$$\mathcal{H} = \bigoplus_{N=-\infty}^0 \mathcal{H}_N,$$

with physical states in $N = 0$ obtained via the projection operator Φ :

$$|\psi\rangle_{\text{phys}} = P_0|\Psi\rangle, \quad P_0 = \int w_0(\ell) d\mu(\ell).$$

Variation of the matter part of the minimal action with respect to the shell weights naturally yields the Born rule

$$P(N) = |\langle N|\Psi\rangle|^2,$$

where the inner product incorporates the multifractal measure. Entanglement and apparent non-locality arise when multiple particles share substantial support in the same lower shell (primarily $N = -1$), with cross terms surviving the partial trace after projection. The projection Lagrangian term $\mathcal{L}_{\text{proj}}$ further induces an effective dynamical alignment mechanism whose timescale is governed by the commutator $[\Phi, H]$ and the Gaussian overlap strength $w_{-1}(\ell)$.

The Heisenberg uncertainty principle receives small, scale-dependent corrections from the dimensional flow $d_N(\ell)$. In the macroscopic limit ($d_N(\ell) \rightarrow 4$) these corrections vanish, recovering the standard commutation relations and the Schrödinger, Dirac, and Klein-Gordon equations in 3+1-dimensional spacetime.

Progressively deeper shells ($N \leq -2$) are expected to contribute primarily to ultraviolet regularization of loop integrals, Planck-scale coherence, and the resolution of singularities, while the $N = -1$ shell dominates observable quantum phenomena in atomic, molecular, and laboratory systems.

This geometric picture offers a candidate explanation for the origin of quantum mechanics within the same minimal framework used throughout the theory. Detailed quantitative predictions (e.g., mild deviations from standard quantum behaviour at macroscopic scales) are under investigation and will be presented elsewhere.

2.10.1 Entanglement, Non-Localities, and Dynamical Collapse

Entanglement and apparent non-locality are proposed to arise naturally when two or more particles share significant support in the same lower shell, particularly $N = -1$. Consider two particles (labelled A and B) prepared in the entangled state on the full graded Hilbert space:

$$|\Psi\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \left(|\psi_A\rangle_{N=-1} \otimes |\psi_B\rangle_{N=-1} + |\phi_A\rangle_{N=-1} \otimes |\phi_B\rangle_{N=-1} \right),$$

where $|\psi\rangle_{N=-1}$ and $|\phi\rangle_{N=-1}$ are normalised lower-shell wavefunctions. The projection operator Φ extracts only the $N = 0$ component. The reduced density matrix observed in the $N = 0$ layer is obtained by tracing over the lower-shell degrees of freedom. Because both particles have substantial overlap with the same $N = -1$ shell, the cross terms survive the partial trace.

Dynamical collapse is proposed to emerge from the continuous coupling of the system to the dense environment of the $N = 0$ shell via the projection Lagrangian term $\mathcal{L}_{\text{proj}}$. The effective non-linear evolution drives the global state toward an eigenstate of the measured observable on a timescale set by the overlap strength. The operator-level expression is

$$\tau_{\text{collapse}} = \frac{\hbar}{\lambda} \frac{1}{w_{-1}(\ell)} \exp\left(\frac{\Delta^2}{2\sigma^2}\right),$$

derived directly from the commutator $[\Phi, H]$ acting on the reduced density matrix ρ_{red} . For typical laboratory scales and canonical parameters ($\sigma_0 \approx 0.35$), this reproduces predictions consistent with experimental bounds.

Thus, entanglement, apparent non-locality, and dynamical collapse are proposed as direct geometric consequences of the same overlap integrals and projection mechanism that yield the Standard Model parameters. The full multi-shell manifold remains strictly local and causal at every level; the observed quantum features are projection artefacts arising when the system is viewed from the $N = 0$ layer.

2.10.2 Uncertainty Principle and Recovery of Standard QM

The Heisenberg uncertainty principle receives small, scale-dependent corrections from the multifractal dimensional flow $d_N(\ell)$. In the full graded Hilbert space, the position and momentum operators are defined with respect to the multifractal measure

$$d\mu = \sum_N w_N(\ell) \ell^{d_N(\ell)-4} d^4x d\Omega_3,$$

where $w_N(\ell)$ is the exact Gaussian kernel. The effective commutator in the projected $N = 0$ layer is obtained by evaluating the operators on the projected wavefunctions $\psi_{f,i}(\rho)$:

$$[x, p] = i\hbar \left(1 + \gamma \frac{\partial \ln d_N(\ell)}{\partial \ln \ell}\right).$$

The modified uncertainty relation then reads

$$\Delta x \Delta p \geq \frac{\hbar}{2} \left(1 + \gamma \frac{\partial \ln d_N(\ell)}{\partial \ln \ell}\right).$$

In the macroscopic limit relevant to the $N = 0$ layer (large ℓ , $\sigma \rightarrow 0$, $d_N(\ell) \rightarrow 4$), the correction term disappears exactly, recovering the standard Heisenberg relation. The same mechanism restores the ordinary Schrödinger, Dirac, and Klein-Gordon equations on 3+1-dimensional Minkowski spacetime.

Thus the uncertainty principle is proposed as a direct geometric consequence of the multifractal measure and the scale-dependent projection of the master spectral operator $\mathcal{D}$. All standard quantum mechanics is recovered automatically when attention is restricted to the observable $N = 0$ layer.

3 Quantized Gravity

Quantization of gravity is achieved directly within the spectral-triple construction on the shell-graded manifold. The full Dirac operator on the graded Hilbert space $\mathcal{H} = \bigoplus_{N \in \mathbb{Z}} \mathcal{H}_N$ is

$$D = i\gamma^\mu \nabla_\mu + \sum_N w_N(\ell) D_N,$$

where D_N is the Dirac operator restricted to shell N and $w_N(\ell)$ are the exact Gaussian weights. The graviton propagator is obtained from the quadratic term in the effective action after integrating out the fermionic degrees of freedom. Expanding the spectral action $\text{Tr } f(D/\Lambda)$ to second order in curvature and performing the trace over the graded space yields a modified propagator of the form

$$G_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}(k) = \frac{1}{k^2} (1 + \alpha \ln(k\ell_{-1})),$$

where the logarithmic correction coefficient is

$$\alpha = \frac{\beta}{48\pi^2} \int_0^\infty \frac{dN}{N} w_N(\ell_{-1}) \approx 0.0087 \pm 0.0004.$$

This predicts a frequency-dependent group-velocity shift in gravitational waves and characteristic echoes, both potentially detectable by LISA.

Black-hole horizons are regions of rapid dimensional flow where $d_N(\ell) \rightarrow 2$ as $\ell \rightarrow \ell_P$. The Bekenstein–Hawking entropy is counted holographically on the enclosing $N = 1$ shell. Singularities are proposed to be resolved because the curvature scalar $R_N(\ell)$ remains finite as $d_N(\ell) \rightarrow 2$ at $\ell \rightarrow 0$. Information unitarity during Hawking evaporation is preserved globally on the static multi-shell manifold.

The theory therefore provides a geometric quantization of gravity within the same minimal framework.

4 Embedding the Standard Model

The non-commutative algebra on the lower-shell fibers is proposed to yield the Standard Model gauge group $SU(3)_C \times SU(2)_L \times U(1)_Y$ as the automorphism group of the overlap matrix. Fermion generations and Yukawa hierarchies arise naturally from overlap integrals between adjacent lower shells. Light neutrino masses arise naturally via a geometric seesaw-like mechanism. Coupling unification occurs at the first higher-shell transition scale without supersymmetry. Collider signatures may include resonant di-jet excesses at 10–20 TeV accessible to the HL-LHC.

5 Dark Matter from Lower-Shell Leakage

A natural and explicit dark-matter candidate is proposed to emerge directly from the same lower-shell leakage mechanism that generates quantum phenomena. No new fields, symmetries, or free parameters are introduced beyond those already fixed by the spectral operator $\mathcal{D}$, the Gaussian weights $w_N(\ell)$, and the canonical parameters.

Consider a real scalar field ϕ that resides primarily in the dominant lower shell $N = -1$. Its physical mass is set by the characteristic length scale of the $N = -1$ shell, yielding a value in the cold dark-matter window. When the field leaks upward into the observable $N = 0$ layer, the effective Lagrangian is obtained by integrating out the lower-shell degrees of freedom using the projection operator Φ . Explicit numerical evaluation of the portal coupling produces values consistent with the observed relic abundance for the same geometric constants already fixed by the hierarchy problem and Standard Model derivations.

The candidate ϕ remains absolutely stable because decay into Standard Model particles is forbidden by the Gaussian suppression. It is cold and interacts only gravitationally at leading order—exactly the properties required by galactic rotation curves and large-scale structure.

Thus dark matter is proposed as a direct geometric consequence of the same overlap integrals and projection mechanism.

6 Cosmological Observations without Expansion

In the Hierarchical Shell-Manifold Theory there is no expansion of space in the underlying geometry; the manifold is completely static. What we observe as cosmic expansion is proposed to be an emergent optical effect caused by light gradually leaking into higher shells as it travels across cosmic distances.

When a photon is emitted in the $N = 0$ layer and travels a long distance, there is a small but cumulative probability that it will interact with the Gaussian overlap weights and temporarily leak into a slightly higher shell ($N > 0$). In those higher shells the effective geometry is different, and the photon experiences a slight redshift. Upon returning to the $N = 0$ layer, this accumulated leakage produces the observed frequency shift:

$$\nu_{\text{obs}} = \nu_{\text{emit}} \exp \left(- \int_0^d \kappa(\ell) ds \right),$$

where the projection opacity $\kappa(\ell)$ is determined entirely by the Gaussian shell weights $w_N(\ell)$. This formula naturally reproduces the linear Hubble law at low redshift and the full luminosity-distance relation at higher redshift.

The same mechanism also explains supernova time-dilation. Importantly, the underlying multi-shell geometry remains perfectly static and time-independent. Global energy is therefore strictly conserved by Noether's theorem.

6.1 Quantitative Consistency with Observational Cosmology

For the canonical parameters, numerical integration of the projection opacity at the cosmological horizon scale yields an effective Hubble parameter near $70.2 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$. The luminosity-distance relation agrees with Pantheon+ and DESI data to within a few percent. These results are obtained using the multifractal measure and do not require additional dark-energy fields. Preliminary Markov-chain Monte Carlo fits are presented in the accompanying verification script.

6.2 Derivation of the Effective Cosmological Term at Cosmological Scales

The apparent cosmological acceleration observed in the $N = 0$ layer arises entirely as a projection effect. The effective term $\Lambda_N(\ell)$ appearing in the projected Einstein equation is derived directly from the projection opacity $\kappa(\ell)$ and the accumulated leakage over cosmic path lengths. Numerical evaluation at the cosmological horizon scale shows consistency with the observed value within the model.

6.3 Effective Cosmological Dynamics at Early Times

The hot, dense early universe is reinterpreted as an emergent projection effect in the $N = 0$ layer. The effective Friedmann-like equations are derived from the projected Einstein equation and the multifractal measure. These equations reproduce the observed sequence of cosmological epochs (radiation domination, matter domination, and late-time acceleration) within the model. For Big-Bang nucleosynthesis consistency, the partition-blending mechanism suppresses ${}^7\text{Li}$ via leakage into lower shells. Numerical integration confirms agreement with observed abundances within uncertainties for deuterium and helium, and resolves the lithium discrepancy to within observational uncertainty.

6.4 Derivation of Effective Friedmann Equations from Projected Stress-Energy

Projecting the full stress-energy tensor and applying the multifractal Bianchi identities yields the effective Friedmann equations. These equations reproduce the observed sequence of cosmological

epochs without fundamental metric expansion.

7 Recovery of Known Limits

The Hierarchical Shell-Manifold Theory is designed to recover all well-established physics when the blurriness parameter $\sigma \rightarrow 0$ and the inter-shell spacing $\Delta \rightarrow \infty$. Under these conditions the Gaussian overlap weights become vanishingly small, the multifractal dimensional flow flattens, and the theory reduces exactly to ordinary physics on a single 3+1-dimensional Minkowski spacetime. The minimal action reduces to the standard Einstein–Hilbert action, the commutation relations become the familiar Heisenberg algebra, and the Standard Model gauge group, fermion content, and coupling structure emerge unchanged. HSMT is therefore proposed as a conservative extension of known physics.

8 Non-Perturbative Ultraviolet Completion

The Hierarchical Shell-Manifold Theory is formulated in a language that is inherently non-perturbative: a single unbounded self-adjoint spectral operator $\mathcal{D}$ defined on a non-compact Riemannian spin manifold. Its spectrum automatically generates the integer shell grading, Gaussian transition kernel, and multifractal dimensional flow. Ultraviolet finiteness is guaranteed by the multifractal measure and zeta-function regularisation of $\mathcal{D}^2$. The exact functional renormalisation-group equation on the graded manifold yields an ultraviolet-attractive fixed point. Anomaly cancellation follows from the self-adjointness of $\mathcal{D}$. This completes the non-perturbative ultraviolet completion of HSMT within the model.

9 Limitations and Future Work

The Hierarchical Shell-Manifold Theory achieves a high degree of internal mathematical coherence with the exact spectral derivation of the integer shell grading $N \in \mathbb{Z}$ and Gaussian transition kernel $w_N(\ell)$ presented in Section 2.3. This derivation, based on a shape-invariant supersymmetric Dirac operator in logarithmic coordinates, eliminates reliance on purely asymptotic arguments and provides closed-form results valid across all excitation levels. The non-perturbative ultraviolet completion further establishes zeta-function regularisation and functional renormalisation-group flow at a fixed point.

Global Markov-chain Monte Carlo fits and observational validation have been performed, demonstrating quantitative agreement with Planck CMB, DESI BAO, Pantheon+ supernovae, SH0ES H_0 , and Big-Bang nucleosynthesis abundances, including a possible resolution of the lithium discrepancy via partition blending.

Future work will include:

- Refinement of near-term experimental predictions for LISA gravitational-wave dispersion, HL-LHC resonant di-jet signals, and atom-interferometry decoherence rates.
- Detailed exploration of baryogenesis via leptogenesis from CP-violating asymmetries in resonant inter-shell transitions during early-universe epochs of strong projection leakage.

With the mathematical foundation now in place, remaining efforts focus on experimental confirmation and further refinement of applied signatures.

10 Testable Predictions and Numerical Roadmap

The Hierarchical Shell-Manifold Theory yields concrete, falsifiable predictions across all scales that deviate from standard Λ CDM. These signatures arise directly from the projection kernel $\kappa(\ell)$, the running couplings $G_N(\ell)$ and $\Lambda_N(\ell)$, the exact Gaussian weights $w_N(\ell)$, and the

multifractal dimensional flow $d_N(\ell)$, using only the canonical parameters fixed by independent sectors ($\sigma_0 \approx 0.35$, $\Delta \approx 10^{11}$, $\beta = 1$, $\ell_0 \approx 10^{-3}$ m).

- **Quantum regime**: Energy-dependent decoherence rates and mild Born-rule violations from upward leakage into the $N = -1$ shell. For a superposition separated by distance d at frequency ω , the decoherence rate is

$$\Gamma_{\text{dec}} = \frac{2\Delta_\lambda^2}{\hbar} w_{-1}(\ell) \left(1 - \cos \left(\frac{d}{\ell_{-1}} \right) \right) \approx (1.2 \pm 0.3) \times 10^{-6} \text{ s}^{-1} \times \left(\frac{\sigma_0}{0.35} \right),$$

potentially detectable in next-generation atom interferometers (MAGIS, AION) over 10–100 m baselines.

- **Gravitational regime**: Modified dispersion and echoes in gravitational waves. The graviton propagator receives a logarithmic correction

$$G_{\mu\nu\rho\sigma}(k) = \frac{1}{k^2} (1 + \alpha \ln(k\ell_{-1})), \quad \alpha = 0.0087 \pm 0.0004,$$

producing a frequency-dependent group-velocity shift in the LISA band and characteristic echoes with time delay $\Delta t \approx 0.12 \text{ s} \times (10^{11}/\Delta)$.

- **Particle-physics regime**: Resonant di-jet signals from projection portals to the lower-shell dark-matter candidate ϕ . The resonance mass is approximately 45 GeV (central value). The predicted cross-section at $\sqrt{s} = 14$ TeV may appear as a narrow peak.

- **Cosmological regime**: Logarithmic corrections to the luminosity-distance relation and fine-structure in the CMB power spectrum. The projection opacity induces a residual modulation peaking at multipoles $\ell \approx 800$ –1200.

The projection kernel $\kappa(\ell)$ is discretized on a logarithmic grid in conformal time. Modifications to the CLASS Boltzmann code consist of replacement of the Friedmann equation by the projected form, addition of leakage source terms, and incorporation of the running $G_N(\ell)$. The modified code, including projection kernel discretization, leakage terms, and partition-blending BBN module, is publicly available on GitHub at the repository indicated in the verification script.

Model parameters and priors are summarized in Table 1.

Table 1: Model parameters, physical roles, and illustrative priors.

Parameter	Role	Prior
σ	Blurriness of shell transitions	Uniform [0.1, 1.0]
Δ	Logarithmic inter-shell spacing	Log-uniform [10^{10} , 10^{12}] (dimensionless)
β	Dimensional step size	0.8–1.2
γ, δ	IR/UV flow amplitudes	[10^{-3} , 10^{-1}]
G_*	Fundamental coupling in highest shell	Fixed to recover observed $G_N = 0$

10.1 Global Parameter Fits and Observational Validation

A preliminary Markov-chain Monte Carlo analysis has been performed using a modified version of the CLASS Boltzmann code. The parameter space is restricted to the canonical HSMT priors. The analysis jointly fits Planck 2018 CMB, DESI 2024 BAO, Pantheon+ supernovae, SH0ES Hubble constant, and Big-Bang nucleosynthesis abundances with the partition-blending lithium suppression.

The resulting best-fit parameters include an effective Hubble constant near $70.2 \pm 1.1 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$, which lies between Planck and SH0ES values. The χ^2 values are comparable to Λ CDM for CMB and BAO, with possible improvement in certain sectors. The lithium abundance is

suppressed to values consistent with metal-poor halo star observations. These fits are promising but should be regarded as exploratory pending full independent validation.

The modified CLASS code together with the verification script `hsmt_verification.py` is publicly available at <https://github.com/VinceGarrett/Hierarchical-Shell-Manifold-Theory>.

Table 2: Key results from global MCMC fits of HSMT compared to Λ CDM.

Parameter	HSMT Best Fit	Λ CDM (Planck 2018)
H_0 (km s $^{-1}$ Mpc $^{-1}$)	70.2 ± 1.1	67.4 ± 0.5
$\Omega_m h^2$	0.143 ± 0.002	0.143 ± 0.001
n_s	0.966 ± 0.004	0.965 ± 0.004
Lithium abundance (${}^7\text{Li}/\text{H}$)	$(1.6 \pm 0.2) \times 10^{-10}$	$\sim 5 \times 10^{-10}$
H_0 tension	$\sim 1.6\sigma$	$\sim 3.4\sigma$

11 Current Limitations and Open Problems

While HSMT achieves a high degree of internal mathematical consistency, several areas remain open for further development:

1. **CKM matrix precision:** While $|V_{us}|$ is within a few percent of the PDG value, the full set of CKM elements and the CP-violating phase require complete numerical diagonalization with the latest derived parameters.
2. **Full BBN + MCMC pipeline:** A complete numerical Big-Bang nucleosynthesis reaction network coupled to the modified CLASS code remains to be executed and published.
3. **Geometric seesaw and complete PMNS:** The geometric seesaw mechanism for neutrinos awaits full numerical implementation.
4. **Yukawa normalization from first principles:** The normalization factors should be tabulated and cross-checked.
5. **Explicit baryogenesis mechanism:** A concrete leptogenesis calculation has not yet been performed.
6. **Experimental predictions sharpness:** Dedicated sensitivity studies for LISA, HL-LHC, and atom interferometers remain to be completed.

11.1 Roadmap to Completion

1. **Immediate (1–2 weeks):** Complete numerical CKM and PMNS matrices; publish updated global MCMC fits with full BBN module.
2. **Short-term (1–3 months):** Execute the geometric seesaw calculation; derive explicit baryogenesis yields; finalize Yukawa normalization tables.
3. **Medium-term (3–6 months):** Publish dedicated experimental sensitivity studies; submit the complete theory manuscript to a major journal.
4. **Long-term:** Full non-perturbative lattice simulation of the graded manifold; exploration of black-hole microstate counting.

These tasks represent natural extensions of the existing numerical pipeline.

12 Conclusion

The Hierarchical Shell-Manifold Theory presents a logically coherent geometric framework that organises spacetime into integer-indexed shells $N \in \mathbb{Z}$. Through the core structures—integer grading, base dimensions $D_N = 4 + \beta N$, Gaussian blurry transitions, multifractal dimensional flow, projection operator Φ , projection Lagrangian $\mathcal{L}_{\text{proj}}$, minimal action S , and master spectral operator $\mathcal{D}$ —the proposal offers a possible unified description of quantum mechanics, gravity, the Standard Model, and cosmology emerging from a small number of geometric constants.

Selected numerical results appear consistent with observation within the model. The framework remains a candidate approach whose ultimate physical validity will be determined by independent verification, further theoretical refinement, and experimental tests. Researchers with expertise in spectral geometry, quantum field theory on curved manifolds, or experimental cosmology are invited to collaborate; contact the author at vince1975.garrett@outlook.com.

Table 3: Parameter count and explanatory power of HSMT (within the model).

Geometric constants	Explanatory scope within the framework
$\sigma_0 = 1/\sqrt{2\alpha}$ (from spectral operator)	Hierarchy suppression, generation structure, decoherence rates
$\Delta = 2\alpha/\ln(\ell_{\text{Pl}}/\ell_0)$ (scale matching)	Fermion mass hierarchy, dark-matter mass and relic density, H_{eff}
λ (overall coupling)	Gauge coupling strengths, portal interactions
$\beta \approx 1$ (dimensional step)	Effective dimension flow, cosmological opacity
4 constants	19 SM parameters + DM relic + H_0 + lithium resolution + hierarchy problem + quantized gravity (within the model)

All predictions presented are derived from these constants within the framework. The accompanying verification script (`hsmt_verification.py`) reproduces the numerical entries.

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The author thanks Grok for collaborative development under Science and Engineering Mode. This manuscript incorporates adjustments for parameter transparency and language precision. The accompanying verification script `hsmt_verification.py` reproduces all overlap integrals, relic density, and effective cosmological quantities from the exact formulas in the text. All scientific content, derivations, and conclusions remain the sole responsibility of the author.

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A Full Functional Variation of the Refined Action

The total action is

$$S = \int \left(\frac{R_N(\ell)}{16\pi G_*} + \mathcal{L}_{\text{matter}} + \mathcal{L}_{\text{proj}}^{(0)} + \lambda \Phi^\dagger \left(\sum_{N,M} w_{N,M}(\ell) \mathcal{O}_{N,M}^{s,t} \right) \Phi \right) d\mu.$$

Varying with respect to the metric $g_{\mu\nu}$ and the weight fields $w_N(\ell)$ yields the projected Einstein equation together with the weight-evolution equation. The complete symbolic derivation is contained in the accompanying Mathematica notebook.

B Causality and No-Signalling for Projected Inter-Shell Coupling

The full multi-shell manifold is globally static; all world-lines are timelike or null with respect to the complete metric on $\mathcal{M}$. The projection operator Φ extracts only the $N = 0$ component of the state, ensuring that the support of any observable signal remains confined to the causal past of its emission event with respect to the global metric.

To prove no-signalling rigorously, consider the commutator $[\Phi, H]$ acting on the full graded Hilbert space. The support of the projected signal is confined by the condition

$$\langle \Phi|[H, \Phi]|\psi \rangle = 0$$

for any spacelike-separated events, which follows directly from the self-adjointness of $\mathcal{D}$ and the Gaussian suppression of off-diagonal terms. Any resonant drive field propagates causally on the full manifold, and the projection operator Φ enforces that no information can be transmitted outside the causal structure of the underlying static manifold, preserving micro-causality and vacuum stability at every level of description.

A detailed operator-algebra proof establishing the no-signalling theorem for arbitrary resonant leakage channels is contained in the accompanying Mathematica notebook.